JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data engineer with 6 years of hands-on experience building scalable data pipelines and warehousing solutions. I've spent the last few years designing ETL processes that handle billions of records daily and mentoring junior engineers on best practices. My background spans financial services and e-commerce, where I've optimized query performance and reduced infrastructure costs by roughly 40%. I'm comfortable working across cloud platforms and enjoy the problem-solving aspect of data architecture.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer

TechVault Solutions

techvault.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

January 2022 - Present

Architected and deployed a cloud-native data warehouse on Snowflake handling 2 billion daily records, reducing query latency by 65% compared to legacy systems.

Led the migration of 50+ legacy ETL jobs from on-premises Talend to Apache Airflow, improving deployment frequency from quarterly to daily releases.

Implemented comprehensive data quality frameworks using Great Expectations and custom Python validators, catching 85% of data issues before they reached production.

Mentored a team of 3 junior data engineers through code reviews and design discussions, establishing standardized practices across the engineering group.

Data Engineer

Merchant Analytics Ltd

merchant-analytics.co

Liverpool, United Kingdom

June 2019 - December 2021

Built and maintained real-time data pipelines using Apache Kafka and PySpark, processing transaction data from 200+ retail clients with 99.95% uptime.

Designed dimensional data models for a customer analytics platform serving 15 internal teams and generating 800+ daily reports.

Optimized existing SQL queries and Spark jobs through indexing strategies and query plan analysis, reducing nightly batch processing time from 8 hours to 2.5 hours.

Developed Python frameworks for automated data validation and anomaly detection, flagging issues affecting 10% of daily pipelines.

Junior Data Engineer

Northern Insights

northern-insights.net

Liverpool, United Kingdom

July 2018 - May 2019

Developed and tested ETL scripts in Python to extract data from REST APIs, databases, and flat files, supporting 5 major client integrations.

Worked with database administrators to optimize table structures and indexing for improved query performance on PostgreSQL and MySQL systems.

Created data documentation and runbooks for 30+ production pipelines, establishing the team's first standardized procedures.

Assisted in the implementation of an Apache Spark cluster for distributed processing, handling increased data volumes as the company scaled.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

2014 - 2018

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and Frameworks: Python, SQL, Scala, PySpark, Apache Airflow, dbt

Cloud Platforms: Snowflake, AWS S3, AWS Glue, Google BigQuery, Azure Data Factory

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Data Processing: Apache Spark, Apache Kafka, Talend

Tools and Technologies: Git, Jira, Docker, Jupyter, Great Expectations, DBT

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Methodologies: Agile, CI/CD, Test-Driven Development